

# Dave Yarwood

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## SUMMARY

Software engineer with 12 years of experience building distributed systems, data platforms, and AI-powered products. I work across teams to set engineering standards, lead architecture, and grow other engineers. Most recently I pioneered LLM-assisted development and AI product infrastructure at GovSpend, and I now work at Fieldguide.

## EXPERIENCE

**Senior Software Engineer - Fieldguide** Aug 2026 - Present  
<https://fieldguide.com>

**Senior Software Engineer II - GovSpend** Oct 2023 - Aug 2026  
<https://govspend.com>

- o Pioneered LLM-assisted development across the company, building shared tools that cut biweekly release prep from 1-2 hours to minutes and help engineers write high-quality RFCs.
- o Established formal technical design (RFC) and deployment standards, raising engineering quality across every team.
- o Led AI work spanning research, prompt strategy, and infrastructure, including summaries for over 2 million meetings and semantic search over government documents.
- o Cut infrastructure costs by profiling slow queries, dropping unused indexes, and cleaning up terabytes of MongoDB and Elasticsearch data.

**Senior Software Engineer - Kevel (formerly Adzerk)** Nov 2014 - Sep 2023  
<https://kevel.com>

- o Key engineer during growth from 10 to 150+ employees; implemented high-performance ad engines and APIs, oversaw campaign management UI evolution.
- o Won high-profile enterprise customers by overhauling authentication to support SSO (SAML, OIDC) and implementing Content Security Policy, raising Mozilla Observatory score from F to A.
- o Led technical design processes, mentored dozens of engineers, and streamlined feature delivery with CI/CD pipelines.

**Disability Examiner / ODAR Specialist - NC Disability Determination Services** Aug 2008 - Nov 2014

- o Determined eligibility for Social Security disability by analyzing complex medical and vocational records, managing a demanding caseload while serving as the sole liaison for federal hearings offices.

## EDUCATION

**University of North Carolina - Chapel Hill** 2004 - 2008  
Bachelor's degree - Music Composition and Bassoon Performance

## PROJECTS

**Alda** A text-based programming language for music notation, MIDI production, and generative music. 2012 - present

- o <https://github.com/alda-lang/alda>
- o Popular open-source project (5,000+ GitHub stars), featured on HackerNews
- o Presented at international conferences, including ICFP, Compose Conference, and Strange Loop

## SKILLS

**Technical design:** Distributed architecture, Domain-Driven Design, SDLC, testing approaches  
**People:** Onboarding, leading, mentoring, documentation, creative problem solving, planning and prioritization, collaboration with stakeholders  
**AI:** Prompt engineering, semantic search, Langchain, Langfuse, LLM-assisted development  
**Backend:** Temporal, Go, TypeScript, Node.js, Clojure, Java, C#, REST APIs  
**Frontend:** TypeScript, React, JavaScript, XState, UX design, SSO, SAML, OIDC, ClojureScript  
**Databases:** Relational databases (SQL Server, PostgreSQL), NoSQL / document databases (MongoDB, Elasticsearch, Redis, DynamoDB)

**DevOps:** Linux, Bash, Git, Amazon Web Services (AWS), Google Cloud Platform (GCP), Datadog, monitoring, logging, telemetry, observability, continuous integration & delivery (CI/CD), standards compliance

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